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The Washington Post

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Windy 28/17 • Tomorrow: Cold 34/20 **B20**

Democracy Dies in Darkness

SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 1, 2026 • \$6



STEPHANIE SCARBROUGH/AP

Skater taps grief, achieves glory

BY ROBERT SAMUELS

The ice rink at the base of the lush mountains of northern Italy became Maxim Naumov's sanctuary. The wood rafters sloped upward like the ceiling of a cathedral, and the sun beamed through slits of stained-glass windows. Benoît Richaud, a pale, bald French figure skating choreographer who ran a camp for elite skaters there, often wondered whether the place was sometimes visited by the Holy Spirit.

Naumov, 24, had his mother's

After his parents died in the DCA crash, he healed on the ice and won spot in Olympics

Maxim Naumov skates last month in St. Louis at a make-or-break contest to decide the U.S. Olympic roster.

square jaw and his father's penetrating eyes, and in the summer of 2025, he longed for his athletic pursuits to connect with something divine. He relished this time outside the Boston suburbs, away from the familiar sheet of ice where he spent hours being coached by his mom and dad, far from the home filled with pictures that devastated him and videos he could not bear to watch.

"What do you want to accomplish?" Richaud recalled asking him.

"I want to make the Olympic team,"

SEE NAUMOV ON A12

Trump's 250-foot arch would dwarf Lincoln Memorial

MONUMENT PROPOSED FOR NATION'S 250TH

Architectural experts worry about scale and location

BY DAN DIAMOND, HANNAH DORMIDO AND TIM MEKO

The White House stands about 70 feet tall. The Lincoln Memorial, roughly 100 feet. The triumphal arch President Donald Trump wants to build would eclipse both if he gets his wish.

Trump has grown attached to the idea of a 250-foot-tall struc-

ture overlooking the Potomac River, according to two people who spoke on the condition of anonymity to describe his comments, a scale that has alarmed some architectural experts who initially supported the idea of an arch but expected a far smaller one.

The planned Independence Arch is intended to commemorate

SEE ARCH ON A10

Judge orders release of 5-year-old held by ICE

Detention of child and his father in Minneapolis added to searing tensions

BY GAYA GUPTA

A federal judge has ordered 5-year-old Liam Conejo Ramos and his father, Adrian Alexander Conejo Arias, to be released from federal immigration custody after the pair were detained in their driveway in Minnesota last month, sparking outrage nationwide and protests at the family

detention center in Dilley, Texas, where they have been held.

In a sharply worded statement, U.S. District Judge Fred Biery said the administrative warrants issued by the executive branch to its own agents "do not pass probable cause muster."

"That is called the fox guarding the henhouse," he wrote. "The Constitution requires an independent judicial officer."

SEE ICE ON A5

Monitoring ICE: Thousands step up in Minnesota to volunteer. **A6**

Crackdown continues: Judge denies bid for immediate halt. **A7**

Epstein photos appear to show Andrew kneeling over a female

BY KARLA ADAM

LONDON — A man who appears to be Andrew Mountbatten-Windsor, the now former prince and Duke of York, is photographed kneeling on all fours and positioned over a female person.

An email account labeled "The Duke" messages convicted sex offender Jeffrey Epstein to suggest dinner "and lots of privacy" at Buckingham Palace, a month after Epstein's house arrest ended in 2010. The message is signed "A."

Epstein emails "The Duke" account to say he has a "beautiful" Russian woman he would like him to meet.

The latest tranche of Epstein documents released on Friday by the Justice Department offers yet more documentary evidence of the long-running association

SEE EPSTEIN ON A13

S.C. measles outbreak nation's worst in a quarter-century

Virus takes hold in area where vaccination coverage has fallen below levels needed to stop spread

BY LENA H. SUN

South Carolina is battling the country's largest measles outbreak since the disease was eliminated from the United States more than a quarter-century ago, with more than 840 cases overwhelmingly in unvaccinated children and adults.

The outbreak that started in October has taken hold in the Spartanburg area where vaccination coverage has fallen below levels needed to stop transmission. Vaccination rates for measles have slipped nationwide, as religious exemptions to school immunization mandates rise and clusters of susceptible people allow the highly contagious virus to spread.

In 16 weeks, South Carolina infections surpassed the case count over seven months in Texas, where an outbreak last year drove the country's highest an-

SEE MEASLES ON A11



JUAN DIEGO REYES/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

A provider assesses a person with measles symptoms in Spartanburg, South Carolina, on Friday.

Another federal shutdown begins, but a speedy end is likely this time

BY JACOB BOGAGE AND RILEY BEGGIN

The second government shutdown of President Donald Trump's second term began early Saturday, as aggressive immigration enforcement in Minneapolis derailed congressional negotiations to fund the agencies driving the administration's policies.

Lawmakers missed a midnight deadline to approve six new spending bills because the Senate changed some of the measures after the House passed them, in response to deadly shootings of U.S. citizens by federal immigration agents in Minnesota.

Without funding, the IRS will shutter just days into tax season. Money for housing assistance programs could be at risk in the aftermath of a winter storm that sent temperatures in much of the

SEE SHUTDOWN ON A9

SPORTS

Get a look between the sheets at the college Excel championships. **B1**

ARTS & STYLE

Murder defendant Nick Reiner's life of privilege, pills and pain.

TRAVEL

A dozen destinations without crowds for your 2026 wish list.

BOOK WORLD

The Cartel Trilogy author retired. Turns out he had more to say.

\$138

SUNDAY COUPON INSERTS

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